effect, the governor controls the outcome of the MPC. A better design would have one vote for the RBI governor and four votes for independents. In that design, in order to have her way, the RBI governor would need to persuade at least two out of the four independents. This seems like a healthy reduction in the power of the governor.

Decision making through a vote, with genuine dispersion of power, qualitatively improves meetings. When one or two persons dominate a room, others tend to be listless and uninterested. The knowledge and interests of all person are not vigorously brought into the room. When a certain set of persons have a vote each, each of them is fully energized to participate in the discussion, knowing that she has equal power and that her vote counts. This improves the very *discussion* that precedes the vote.

When a meeting ends in a vote, everyone in the room thinks better and participates more. This idea can be used in a wide variety of meetings in order to improve the dispersion of power and the brainpower that is brought to bear on a question.

Formal voting systems, backed by transparency, provide a powerful mechanism for aggregating knowledge and resolving political conflicts. Particularly in an early-stage liberal democracy, where the art of give and take in political negotiation is only weakly understood, formal voting systems can often mark a big step forward from the autocratic ways.

Summing up

We should recognize the scarcity and value of criticism, and create an environment where we disagree without being disagreeable. Every critic is engaged in altruism, and harming her own self-interest, by speaking truth to power. There is a market failure, in the form of an under-supply of criticism owing to positive externalities.

It is in the self-interest of the policymaker to engage with critics, so as to improve by discovering areas of weakness in the policy work. When the